

IRELAND — Business Formation Guide

RKPT TECH LTD | EU Business & Technology Hub *Verified against official government sources — September 2026*

1. Snapshot

Recommended structure	Private Company Limited by Shares (LTD)
Authority	Companies Registration Office (CRO) via CORE
Government incorporation fee	€50 (online Form A1)
Minimum capital	None (no general minimum)
Typical incorporation time	~5 working days (expedited) to ~10 working days (ordinary)
Critical requirement	EEA-resident director (or bond/certificate alternative)

2. Recommended Structure

Private Company Limited by Shares (LTD) — governed by the Companies Act 2014, can be formed by one or more persons, and uses a single-document constitution. An LTD can have just one director.

3. Company Formation — Step by Step

1. **Select LTD structure**
2. **Check company name** with the CRO — avoid identical, misleading, or restricted names
3. **Arrange an Irish registered office**
4. **Identify director(s)** — check whether the **EEA-resident director requirement** (Section 137) is satisfied (see Section 8)

5. **Appoint a company secretary** — for a single-director company, the secretary must be a different person
 6. **Prepare the constitution** (one-document format for an LTD)
 7. **Select NACE activity classification**
 8. **Prepare and file Form A1** via the CRO's **CORE** online system, with the constitution
 9. **Complete beneficial-ownership registration**
 10. **Register with Irish Revenue** for Corporation Tax, VAT and PAYE as applicable
 11. **Open a business bank account**
 12. **File the first Annual Return** (see Section 6)
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4. Documents & Information Required

- Company name
 - Registered office address in Ireland
 - Director details, including a **PPSN**, or — for directors without one — a **Verified Identity Number (VIN)** obtained via a sworn Form VIF declaration
 - Company secretary details
 - Subscriber/shareholder details and share capital
 - NACE activity classification
 - Constitution
 - EEA-residence evidence for at least one director, or Section 137 bond / Section 140 certificate documentation
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5. Costs (Government fees — separated from other costs)

Item	Government fee
Form A1 incorporation (online, CORE)	€50
Company name reservation	

(28 days)	€25 (credited against the incorporation fee if used within the reservation period)
Annual Return (B1, online)	€20

Section 137 bond (where no EEA-resident director is available): the bond value is typically **€25,000**, but this is a security/guarantee mechanism, not a fee itself — the actual premium paid to obtain the bond from an authorised provider is commonly around **€1,600–€2,000**. This is not an incorporation fee and should never be presented as one.

Typical additional (third-party) costs: registered office service, company secretary service, accountant, legal services, Section 137 bond premium (if applicable), banking support.

Indicative overall setup budget: approximately **€500–€1,500+**, excluding the separate Section 137 bond where applicable and unusual licensing costs.

6. Timeframe

Stage	Indicative time
Documentation preparation	2–5 working days
CRO expedited route (Fé Phráinn)	~5 working days
CRO ordinary online route	~10 working days
Revenue tax registrations	Variable
Banking	1–4+ weeks
Full operational setup	2–6 weeks
First Annual Return	Due 6 months after incorporation (no financial statements required on this first return)

7. Tax & Ongoing Compliance

Item	Rate
Corporation Tax — trading income	12.5%
Corporation Tax — passive/non-trading income	25%
VAT — standard rate	23%
VAT registration threshold	€42,500 (services) / €85,000 (goods)
Universal Social Charge (USC)	0.5%–11% depending on income band
Employee PRSI	4.20% until 30 Sept 2026; 4.35% from 1 Oct 2026
Employer PRSI	11.40% from 1 Oct 2026 (reduced rate 9.15% for weekly earnings ≤ €441)
Minimum wage	€14.15/hour from January 2026

Ongoing obligations: CRO annual return (B1), financial statements (from the second annual return onward), Corporation Tax (CT1), VAT/PAYE, beneficial-ownership updates, company register maintenance.

8. Important Information

- **The EEA-resident director requirement is the single biggest issue for foreign founders.** At least one director generally must be resident in an EEA state — UK residents no longer qualify post-Brexit. Without one, the company can use the **Section 137 bond** mechanism (guarantee value ~€25,000; premium ~€1,600–€2,000), or apply for a **Section 140 certificate** if it has a real and continuous link with economic activity in Ireland.
- Employer PRSI and employee PRSI rates both increase from **1 October 2026** — factor this into any post-1-October payroll planning.
- **Immigration is separate from incorporation.** The **Start-up Entrepreneur Programme (STEP)** requires minimum funding of €50,000 per founder for an innovative proposal, and can lead to Stamp 4 after 5 years. Owning a company does not automatically create immigration rights.

- Bank account approval is a separate KYC process from incorporation and is never guaranteed.

Disclaimer: Fees, thresholds and requirements change and should be reconfirmed at cro.ie or revenue.ie before reliance. This is general information, not legal, tax or immigration advice.

9. Official Sources (checked September 2026)

- Companies Registration Office (CRO) — <https://www.cro.ie>
- CORE (online filing) — <https://core.cro.ie>
- Revenue Commissioners — <https://www.revenue.ie>
- Immigration Service Delivery (ISD) — <https://www.irishimmigration.ie>